

Cohen

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interruption of World War II, when he served in the North African campaign.

He was pleased to hear of Tanner's allegiance and quick to remind that Earl Weaver (the very successful manager of the Baltimore Orioles) was "another one of my boys" in the minors.

But then, Andy Cohen has seen 'em all in baseball. His second year in the majors, for instance, 1928, was unique in that one generation of baseball greats passed on and another took its place. Ty Cobb and Tris Speaker ended their careers in '28, and that year a brash rookie, who would later make his mark as a manager, Leo Durocher, debuted with the New York Yankees.

In 1926, Andy's rookie season, there was another rookie on the Giants, a 17-year-old from Louisiana, who would thrill Giant fans for two decades. That was Mel Ott.

It's quite a thing in sum. Andy Cohen played for a manager, John McGraw, who was a star with the old Baltimore Orioles, the Orioles of Wee Willie Keeler and Hughie Jennings, scourges of the fledgling majors in the 1890s, men credited with inventing inside baseball, originators of the cut-off play and the Baltimore chop and who refined the art of base stealing, and who found you could win in baseball by using not only your arms and legs, but your head.

And Andy Cohen managed the current boss, Earl Weaver, of the new Orioles, using McGraw-like guile and strategy to battle the talent-rich and money-rich Red Sox and Yankees on even terms in the American League East.

That's why it's good to see No. 23 dutifully trotting out to the first base coaching box every night at Dudley Field. It's a pleasant reminder that the past and the present and the future aren't such strangers after all.